01. Cosmos Bay

Comet Cup · upgrade blueprint · src/kart/tracks/bay.ts

Where it is now

2.8 km seafront loop: promenade, hillside town, lighthouse, cable-stayed bridge, cove jump, causeway, pier jump (boost only). Lap 2 wind; last lap swell.

What is wrong

It drives like every other track: a wide road, a fork, a jump. The sea is scenery, not something you race against.

Core mechanic

The tide. The sea level moves on a cycle during the race. The causeway, the beach road and the harbour floor flood and drain, so the fastest line changes as the race goes on. Wet road is slower and slides; standing water is slower still.

Signature moments

- Breaking waves over the promenade at set intervals: time your run through the gap between waves, or take the higher, slower town road.
- A drawbridge on the harbour that rises and falls: cross when down, jump it when half up (boost), or wait.
- A beach section only open at low tide: a big short cut when the sea is out, gone when it comes in.

Layout changes

- Keep the promenade, town, lighthouse and bridge.
- Add the low-tide beach short cut and the drawbridge.
- Make the causeway a tide-dependent fork: dry and fast at low tide, slow and wet at high.

Lap changes

- Lap 1: low tide, beach open.
- Lap 2: rising tide, beach closing, waves larger.
- Last lap: high tide, causeway under water, beach shut, drawbridge on a faster cycle.

Engine work needed

- Moving water level that changes surface and speed under the road (force zones / surface patches driven by time).
- Moving road piece: the drawbridge (tilting deck).
- Routes that open and close during a race (the beach).

Rivals

- Rivals read the tide state when choosing the beach route.
- Rivals wait for or time the waves and the drawbridge.

Done when

- Laps of 50-60 s for a good driver; all 3-lap test races finish with no errors.
- Rivals use every route and the core mechanic, with no more than 2 rival falls per race.
- The core mechanic is in play for at least half the lap, not just one set piece.
- A blind test: a screenshot or a 10-second clip of this track could not be mistaken for any other track.

- Item rows are never on the start line; nothing solid blocks a road by accident.